

LI / LO	To sort objects into groups and explain one clear sorting rule.	Success	Notice a property; keep one rule; explain with because.
Prior learning	Name colours and simple 2-D shapes; say how two objects are the same/different.	Vocabulary	sort, group, property, rule, same, different, colour, shape, size, type

DETAILED TEACHING SEQUENCE — follow in order; slide numbers refer to the teaching PowerPoint

Time	Slides	Teacher does / says	Children, check and adapt
0–4	1	Before pupils enter, place mixed objects and two hoops on each table. Change the editable date. Check sharp pencils, mini-whiteboards and partners. Read: 'Today we will sort objects into groups.'	Children collect equipment, read the LI and predict how hoops may be used. If resources are not available, use the set and the slide shapes.
4–9	2	TEACH the definition: sorting means putting objects into groups using one clear rule. Contrast the colour example with the mixed non-example. Explain that a sort must be stated and checked.	Children identify the rule in the first example. Ask: 'Can we check the mixed box without a rule? Can we check the rule if the rule is stated.'
9–14	3–5	REVISIT same/different, reveal the word property, then teach sort, group, property and rule with gestures. Introduce Pip: 'Pip makes mistakes; we explain them kindly.'	Children use 'same/different because...', repeat vocabulary and name one property. Lower/less confident children may struggle to speak.
14–22	6–7	TEACH four steps: notice, choose, say/place, check. MODEL sorting by colour. Say: 'I am sorting by colour. This is red, so it belongs in red.' Check every object at the end.	Children repeat the four steps and track each placement. Emphasise: an object has many properties, but only one tells us which matters now.
22–29	8	GUIDED: pupils point first, rehearse, then explain: 'The blue triangle belongs in the blue group because it is blue.' Repeat with 2–3 real objects. Do not take shouted answers.	Point, partner-rehearse and justify with because. If a child uses shape, ask: 'What is our rule? Is it about shape? red/blue if needed.'
29–36	9–10	MISCONCEPTION: Show Pip's sort. Ask: 'What rule did Pip say? Which object breaks it? How do you know?' Reveal the correction only after pupils explain.	Expected: 'The blue triangle belongs in blue because the rule is colour.' If pupils move a red object to blue, say: 'Does it matter? It does not matter under this rule.'
36–43	11–12	RE-TEACH/DEEPEN: mix the same objects and sort by shape. Ask what changed/stayed the same. Partners choose a rule and repeat each other's explanation.	Children explain that objects stayed the same but the rule/groups changed. Verify both colour and shape rules when applied consistently.
43–56	13–14	INDEPENDENT: Lower—real objects and one shown property. Expected—sort pictures and record rule. Higher/finisher—same six objects, two rules, compare. Circulate asking: 'What is your rule?' 'Does every object follow it?'	Children complete the assigned sheet and show thinking. Move a pupil to more/less support if needed. Pupils prove both rules for every object.
56–60	15	EXIT: ask all three questions. Answers: sort = put into groups; property = colour/shape/size/type; same rule = check every object fairly. Collect sheets and record initials.	Children answer orally/on whiteboard. Use explanations and sheet, not confidence alone. Record rule if a child cannot state or keep a rule.

RESOURCES + READINESS

2 hoops/trays per pair; mixed red/blue circles, squares and triangles; mini-whiteboards; slides; three worksheets; pre-teach sheet. Check projector, date, pencils, object trays and named adult before pupils arrive.

PRE-TEACH (10–12 MIN BEFORE)

Group/initials: _____ Adult: _____ Use 2 red + 2 blue objects. Name colours; place first object in each hoop; match one object; state 'sort by colour'; insert one error; pupil moves and explains. Mark independent / prompted / not vet.

[SEND / ADHD / ODD / EAL](#)

Concrete objects; one instruction at a time; pointing before speaking; sentence stem; reduced set; visual timer; active object-moving role; calm choice of which group first; private correction; larger objects/alternative recording. Initials/adult:

FORMATIVE ASSESSMENT

Listen for the words *property* and *rule*; check every placement; photograph one correct concrete sort if useful. *Secure* = states and applies one rule independently. *Developing* = sorts correctly but needs language prompt. *Not yet* = changes rule or matches randomly.

MISCONCEPTIONS + RESPONSE

Changes rule → restate it and check every object. Sorts by preference → ask which property matters. Different sort judged wrong → show same set sorted twice. Cannot explain → point/move, then co-construct 'because'.

AFTER / NEXT STEP

Needs repeat pre-teach: _____ Secure: _____ Ready to
deepen: _____ Adult notes: _____